

1.DGFiP data breach

Incident Date: July 14 2026

Affected Organisation: French Tax Authority (DGFiP)

What was Taken? : Massive database of 678,000 tax and business records, alongside land registry data.

What Exploits were used: Hackers used compromised login credentials and identity theft of 3 Public officials to gain access to internal records. They used the stolen credentials to log into the agency's internal VPN. This allowed them to bypass perimeter security and mimic an employee working remotely. Once inside the network via the VPN, the attacker utilized a built-in internal database search tool. This allowed them to look up and quietly scrape the financial records of 678,000 taxpayers.

How to Prevent the security breach:

- Secure the login process by using phishing-resistant multifactor Authentication (MFA) that uses physical keys or biometrics, blocking risky logins and regularly changing session tokens
- Restrict and Monitor what users can do by giving employees only access to the exact data they need, setting strict rate limits on databases.
- Monitor VPN activity by tracking when and where employees log into internal networks. Look for logins during unusual hours or from unrecognised, non-company laptops.
- Deploy security software that learns what normal employee behaviour looks like. The system will flag an account if it suddenly starts searching for data it has never accessed before.

2.Abbott Laboratories Attacks

Incident Date: July 2026

Affected Organisation: Abbott Laboratories

What was Taken?: Hackers breached internal legacy systems inside Abbott's cancer diagnostics business, stealing over 22 million doctor-patient notes and 20 million medical orders.

What Exploits were used: Criminals used "vishing" (voice phishing) to call employees and trick them. They stole login details for a Microsoft Entra Single Sign-On (SSO) account. Once inside, they could bypass security and log into connected corporate apps.

How to Prevent the security breach:

Stop Vishing attacks by

- Implementing immediate verification protocols like **Mandatory Out-of-Band Verification**, i.e the employee must send a verification code via an internal tool like Slack, Microsoft Teams, or a corporate email to verify the person's identity before sharing any information.

- Security teams deploying modern, unphishable authentication systems like **FIDO2 / WebAuthn Passkeys**, which replace traditional passwords and SMS codes with hardware security keys (like YubiKeys) or device-based passkeys. These keys are tied to specific website addresses. Even if a caller tricks an employee into typing their credentials, the passkey cannot be stolen over the phone.

3. Romania ANCPI ByteotBreach Attack

Incident Date: July 14 2026

Affected Organisation: Romania's National Agency for Cadastre and Land Registration (ANCPI)

What was Taken? The hacker group ByteToBreach stole employee credentials, internal documents, application code, and system infrastructure data, which they quickly posted for sale on a dark web forum.

What Exploits were used: The attacker gained initial entry into the ANCPI network using valid employee credentials. These usernames and passwords had leaked previously and were already freely available on public internet forums, and the accounts did not have proper Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) protections; the attacker was able to simply log right into the perimeter network without needing to break past a firewall.

How to Prevent the security breach:

- **Enforce Phishing-Resistant MFA:** Deploy hardware security keys (like YubiKeys) or strict mobile number-matching systems. If a hacker buys an employee's password on the dark web, they still cannot log in without the physical security key.
- **Automate Credential Screening:** Implement automated tools that continuously scan the dark web for employee emails and passwords. If a corporate password leaks online, the system should automatically force a password reset before a hacker can use it.

4. NYC Health + Hospitals (NYC H+H) cyberattack

Incident Date: November 25 2025

Affected Organisation: NYC Health + Hospitals

What was Taken: Biometric scans, including fingerprints and palm prints; standard identifiers like Social Security numbers, driver's licenses, tax IDs, and passports; medical data including detailed clinical diagnoses, medication lists, lab test results, and health insurance information. Location data, including precise geolocation metadata harvested from photos of ID documents that patients uploaded.

What Exploits were used: Cybercriminals broke into the network by exploiting a security compromise at an unnamed third-party vendor that had access to the hospital system, utilising a method called "ClickFix" to trick users into running malicious

commands via fake web verification prompts, allowing them to stage stolen files in quiet cloud storage buckets.

How to prevent the security breach:

- Stop the ClickFix Trap by blocking command-line tools, training employees on new scams, and using web browser isolation technology
- Guard third-party vendors by implementing zero trust architecture, i.e they should only have access to the exact files they need for their job. Also enforce strong MFA for any vendor logging into the system.

5. AssuranceAmerica CyberAttack

Incident Date: March 16 2025

Affected Organisation: AssuranceAmerica

What was Taken: Hackers stole millions of users' customer data files, including Driver's License Numbers. Personal Information like full names, addresses, phone numbers, some Social Security numbers and Insurance Records

What Exploits were used: The attackers used a targeted **phishing attack** directed at a single company employee, stealing their username and password (credentials). This allowed the attackers to simply log in to the network, looking like a real worker.

How to prevent the security breach:

This attack can be prevented by

- Stopping password theft with better authentication by moving away from text-message or mobile app codes for Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA). Use physical USB keys or fingerprint scanners, which cannot be tricked by fake phishing websites.
- Train employees with high-quality phishing simulations by regularly testing them with realistic fake phishing emails. Use the results to retrain those who fall for the tricks.
- Establish strict rules that the IT support team will never ask employees for their passwords over the phone or text
- Install advanced security software on every work computer to stop "infostealer" malware from quietly scraping credentials.

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